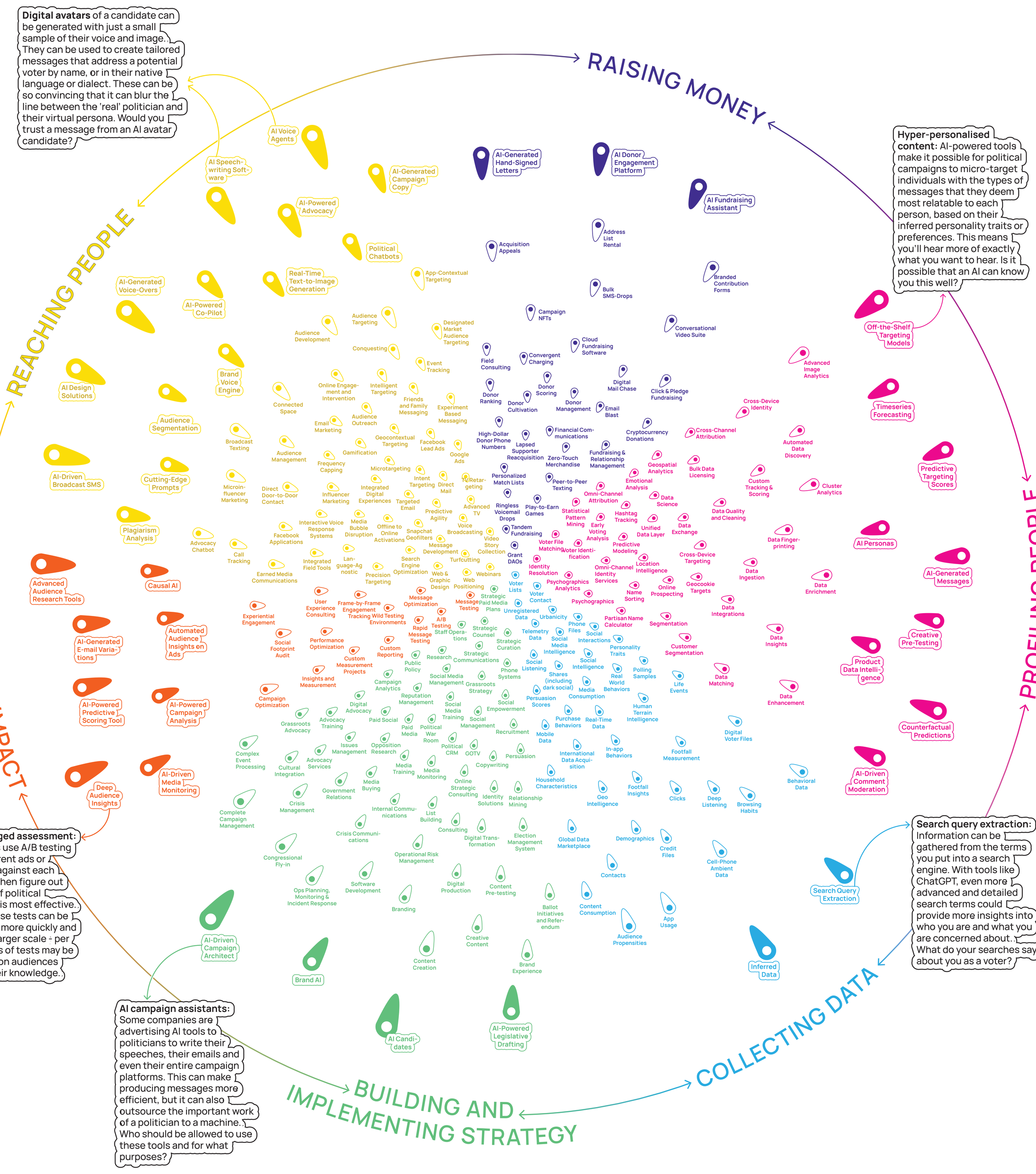
AI: Amplifying Influence

Introducing the Tools of the AI-Powered Influence Industry

How do politicians seem to know what messages we want to see and hear? Behind the scenes, an influence industry is hard at work.

The influence industry sells digital services to political campaigns and other influencers, claiming to help sway your opinions and your vote. With AI, traditional influencing methods are 'supercharged'; they have become cheaper, faster, more targeted and more persuasive.

The kinds of tools campaigns are using go far beyond the 'political deepfakes' that grab public attention. This graphic represents the nearly 300 digital services advertised on the websites of companies in the influence industry. The filled-in shapes show methods that are currently being supercharged by AI. Learn more about a few common methods you may have experienced firsthand without realising it.